



STEWARDSHIP TOOL

The 30-Day Post-Event Calendar

How the first thirty days after an event turn one-time generosity into a lasting relationship.

WHAT'S INSIDE

Thank quickly

Gratitude goes out before the final numbers do.

Record carefully

Capture every gift, note, and next step.

Report impact

Show donors what their support made possible.

Renew wisely

Set up the next right step while it's warm.

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THE PRINCIPLE

The event isn't over when the room empties

Most organizations treat the event as the finish line. In advancement work, it's only the middle. The ask happened, the gift was made, and now the relationship needs tending. The first 30 days decide whether donors feel like participants in the mission or people who completed a transaction.

OPERATING RULE

No major event is complete until gifts are reconciled, donors are thanked, sponsors are recognized, relationship notes are captured, and a post-event impact update has gone out.

Who needs follow-up

AUDIENCE	WHAT THEY NEED AFTER THE EVENT	BEST FOLLOW-UP
Major donors	Personal confirmation that their support was seen and mattered.	Leadership call, handwritten note, short impact update, future visit invitation.
First-time donors	A welcome into the mission and a simple explanation of what happens next.	Warm first-gift email or card, impact story, invitation to stay connected.
Sponsors	Recognition, evidence of visibility, and confidence the partnership was worth it.	Sponsor-specific thank-you, photos, social links, recap, renewal note later.
Guests and attendees	A clear bridge from one event to an ongoing relationship.	Broad thank-you, photos, mission recap, low-pressure next step.
Board members	A specific stewardship role and a request for relationship intelligence.	Assigned calls, notes, introductions, and conversation notes.
Volunteers and staff	Appreciation and a debrief path while details are still fresh.	Thank-you note, debrief, improvement list, ownership for next year.
Families and community	A sense the event was part of a larger mission, not just a fundraiser.	Story-based recap, photos, and what their support made possible.

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OVERVIEW

30 days at a glance

The month has a rhythm. Each week has one job, and each job sets up the next. Use this as the spine, then work the detailed checklists that follow.

Days 0–2	Days 3–7	Days 8–14	Days 15–21	Days 22–30
Gratitude and control Broad thank-you, public post, gift reconciliation, top follow-up list, board assignments.	Personal stewardship Calls, handwritten notes, sponsor packet, first-time donor welcome, host notes.	Data and sorting Segment the list, enter CRM notes, identify top opportunities, collect proof points.	Impact report Send a short recap with a story, a number, a photo, and the next step.	Debrief and next step Hold the debrief, review incomplete follow-up, plan visits, renewals, and the board update.

DAY RANGE	PRIMARY FOCUS	REQUIRED ACTIONS
0-2	Gratitude and control.	Broad thank-you, public post, gift reconciliation, top follow-up list, board assignments.
3-7	Personal stewardship.	Calls, handwritten notes, sponsor packet, first-time donor welcome, board and host notes.
8-14	Data and sorting.	Segment list, enter CRM notes, identify top opportunities, collect proof points.
15-21	Impact communication.	Send the mini impact report or a short recap with story, number, photo, and next step.
22-30	Debrief and next step.	Hold the debrief, review incomplete follow-up, plan visits, sponsor renewals, board update.

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DAYS 0-2

The first 48 hours

The first two days are about gratitude and control. Get thanks out fast and get your records straight, in that order.

TIMING	ACTION	OWNER	NOTES
Day 0-1	Send a broad thank-you email to attendees, donors, sponsors, volunteers, staff, and families.	Advancement lead	Keep it warm and brief. Don't wait for final numbers.
Day 0-2	Reconcile gifts, pledges, sponsorships, auction records, checks, online gifts, and the attendee list.	Finance / admin	Capture amount, restrictions, payment status, and receipt status.
Day 0-2	Create the top follow-up list: major donors, sponsors, first-time donors, table hosts, and anyone who asked for a conversation.	Advancement lead	Sort by urgency, relationship owner, and next step.
Day 1-2	Assign board thank-you calls or handwritten notes.	Board chair + advancement lead	Give each member a short script and exact names.
Day 1-2	Post a public thank-you and a small photo set.	Comms owner	Recognize the community without overclaiming final impact.

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DAYS 3-7

Personal stewardship

Now the personal touches go out. This is the week that separates a stewarded donor from a thanked one.

ACTION	AUDIENCE	OWNER	COMPLETION STANDARD
Call or personally email top donors and major sponsors.	Top tiers, sponsors, lead givers.	Executive leader, principal, ED, board chair.	Every person on the top list receives a personal touch.
Send the first-time donor welcome.	First-time donors.	Advancement lead or admin.	Message explains mission, gratitude, and what they'll hear next.
Send the sponsor packet.	Sponsors and business partners.	Comms or advancement lead.	Includes photos, links, recognition screenshots, and a preliminary thank-you.
Collect board and table-host notes.	Board members, hosts, committee.	Board chair or advancement lead.	Names, conversations, possible interests, and next steps entered into the CRM.
Write handwritten notes.	Top donors, sponsors, volunteers, special guests.	Assigned staff and board.	Specific and personal, with no generic copy-paste tone.

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DAYS 8-21

Sort, then report

With thanks handled, turn the event into intelligence, then turn that intelligence into a short, honest impact report.

Days 8-14 • Sort the relationships

ACTION	WHY IT MATTERS	OUTPUT
Segment the list by relationship type and giving behavior.	Different people need different next steps, so treating everyone the same wastes attention.	A tagged list: major donor, sponsor, first-time, recurring, guest, volunteer, family, board.
Identify the top 10 to 25 relationship opportunities.	Events create warm leads, and that warmth fades quickly if nobody follows up.	A prospect list with owner, reason for interest, and next action.
Collect 3 to 5 proof points.	Stewardship needs evidence, not just gratitude.	Photos, student quotes, a family story, a program metric, or a sponsor-visibility example.
Update CRM notes and tasks.	Institutional memory keeps the relationship from living in one person's head.	Contact notes, gift records, attendance, interests, and next task dates.

Days 15-21 • Report the impact

By the third week, you should have enough detail to send a short impact update. This isn't a full annual report. It's a short stewardship piece that says, here's what happened, here's what your support made possible, and here's what comes next.

REPORT SECTION	WHAT TO INCLUDE
Thank-you opening	Name the community of supporters and acknowledge their generosity.
Event result	Share dollars raised, attendance, sponsor count, or participation if final numbers are ready. If not, say they're still being reconciled.
Mission proof	Use one specific story, quote, student moment, family impact, ministry outcome, or photo.
What comes next	Explain the next mission step the event funded or supported.
Continued connection	Invite visits, prayer, volunteering, recurring giving, or future attendance, without turning it into another hard ask.

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DAYS 22-30

Debrief and renewal setup

Close the loop internally. The last week is where this year's event quietly makes next year's event better.

ACTION	OWNER	DECISION OR OUTPUT
Hold an internal event debrief.	Advancement lead + event team.	What to repeat, fix, cut, delegate, and start earlier next year.
Review donor and sponsor follow-up completion.	Advancement lead.	Any missed stewardship touches are assigned immediately.
Review lead and lag measures.	Executive leader + board contact.	Lag: revenue, donors, sponsors. Lead: calls, notes, visits, introductions, CRM notes.
Build the next-step list.	Advancement lead.	Top prospects for visits, sponsor renewals, recurring-gift invitations, and board introductions.
Schedule the board update.	Board chair.	Report results and relationship follow-up, not only money raised.

BEFORE THE NEXT EVENT

Build this 30-day plan into the event timeline from the start. The event isn't complete until the stewardship loop is closed.

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COPY YOU CAN USE

Templates

Four short messages cover most of the first month. Keep them warm, specific, and human. Fill the brackets, cut anything that sounds like a form letter.

1 • Broad thank-you

Subject: Thank you for making [Event Name] possible

Thank you for being part of [Event Name]. Your presence and support helped advance [specific mission priority]. We're still reconciling final numbers and stories, but we didn't want to wait to say thank you.

This event matters because [one-sentence mission impact]. We'll send a short impact recap soon so you can see what your generosity helped make possible.

2 • Sponsor thank-you

Subject: Thank you for partnering with [Organization]

Thank you for sponsoring [Event Name]. Your support helped make the event possible and helped fund [specific mission priority]. We're grateful for partners willing to stand behind the mission in a visible way.

Attached are a few photos and recognition links you're welcome to share with your team. We'll also send a short impact recap once final numbers and stories are collected.

3 • Board follow-up request

Subject: Help us close the loop after [Event Name]

Thank you for helping make [Event Name] possible. The next 30 days matter because donors, sponsors, and guests need to hear that their support was seen and that it made a difference.

Please send any useful notes from conversations you had, especially with guests, business owners, sponsors, or first-time attendees. If you're willing to make two thank-you calls this week, reply with the names you'd be comfortable contacting.

4 • First-time donor welcome

Subject: Thank you for your first gift to [Organization]

Thank you for making your first gift to [Organization]. We're grateful you chose to support [specific mission area]. A simple way to understand our mission is this: [one-sentence mission explanation].

Your gift helps make that possible for [students, families, guests, clients, ministry recipients, or community]. We'll keep you updated on the impact of your support. For now, thank you for stepping into the mission with us.

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RUN THE MONTH

Tracker and debrief

Two pages to run the month: a task tracker for who-does-what, and a debrief worksheet for what you learned.

Task tracker

TASK	OWNER	DUE	STATUS
Reconcile gifts, pledges, sponsorships, attendance			
Send broad thank-you email			
Call top donors and major sponsors			
Send sponsor-specific appreciation and photos			
Thank board, committee, volunteers, and staff			
Post public recap and photos			
Collect student, family, staff, or beneficiary stories			
Segment donor list by relationship type and tier			
Send first-time donor welcome note			
Collect board and table-host relationship notes			
Send mini impact report			
Hold event debrief and assign next steps			

Event debrief worksheet

What worked well enough to repeat?	
Where did the event create unnecessary friction?	
Which donors, sponsors, or guests need personal follow-up?	
Which stories or photos best prove the impact?	
Which board members were most helpful, and how?	
What should change before the next event?	
What is the next right relationship step after this event?	